

The Lamp as a Foldable Object

Project:

Design and prototype a functional, ambient lamp using a standard LED lighting kit. Your goal is to manipulate light, shadow, and form using a specific, limited palette of raw materials that are folded together.

Instructions:

Analyze how light interacts with your materials. Sketch at least 5 distinct concepts. Consider: Will the lamp cast dramatic geometric shadows, or provide a completely seamless, soft glow? Consider that your lamp must fit within a 12"L x 9"W x 6"H box.

Before building the full structure, create small material swatches. Hold them up to the LED kit's light source. Test out different ways of folding paper to see how light interacts differently.

Create different lamp demos using basic paper before committing to one design. Once your TA has approved your design, start by constructing the skin out of paper. Test different types of paper to see which works best for the effect you are going for. When the skin is done, stiffen it with structural elements like basswood or wire to hold it in place.

Deliverable(s):

Sketches of at least 5 distinct concepts (in your sketchbook), material fold swatches, lamp demos, and your final lamp.